

Q How important is the role of ISVs/SIs or partners in the growth of MySQL? Is that also championed by your team?

We have a strong partnership with SIs, open source solution providers and VARs across regions. Our channel partners are making a significant difference in the way we sell our solutions. In addition, the growth in the mobile arena offers our channel partners tremendous opportunities through mobile-enabling legacy systems or rolling out new solutions. We have 2000+ ISV partners and this number continues to grow. Our partners help build solutions, co-innovate and take to market the benefits of the world's most popular open source database to a larger audience. These partnerships are essential to complete the MySQL ecosystem and enable its growth in the regions. We have a dedicated channel strategy and team for MySQL.

Q For entrepreneurs within the ecosystem, what does MySQL offer—for them to think about investing energy and resources in partnering with you?

Any organisation, be it a startup, a mid-sized firm or a large enterprise, can achieve faster time to market and reduce costs while deploying virtualised MySQL environments, either on-premises or on the cloud.

For entrepreneurs, the key is increased agility, while reducing costs; with Oracle MySQL Cloud Service, entrepreneurs can get a secure, cost-effective and enterprise-grade MySQL database service that can help them rapidly deploy innovative applications. The Oracle MySQL Cloud Service is simple, automated, integrated and enterprise-ready.

At a higher level, the Oracle Startup Cloud Accelerator, our next-gen acceleration initiative, focuses on reimagining enterprise innovation via partnerships with startups to foster co-development and co-innovation — a winning proposition for the entire

ecosystem. Led by Oracle's R&D organisation, we offer both residential and non-residential/virtual startup programmes, allowing us to work with global startups irrespective of what stages of growth and development they are at.

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Q Could you briefly tell us about the range of offerings for developers?

Oracle is highly committed to developing, supporting and promoting open source software and our contribution has been acknowledged by a lot of developers. Thousands of Oracle engineers are part of open source, MySQL communities and develop code that is freely available. We're committed to providing choices and a lower cost of computing for end users, along with flexibility.

The latest offering of the MySQL Shell offers unmatched ease of development, empowering developers with a single interface to develop, deploy and manage MySQL instances.

In line with Oracle's larger open source commitment, and as part of our contribution to container native technology, we have recently launched a new open source, cloud agnostic, serverless platform, called Fn (<https://fnproject.io>). We have also partnered with the Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF) and

have adopted Docker and Kubernetes as the foundation for our container native strategy. Oracle is also contributing to both these important projects.

Q Are there any special tools or resources to enable database managers and software developers to train themselves on MySQL?

There are plenty of online resources for familiarising yourself with MySQL. We conduct MySQL camps for users every quarter, at our office, and developers from various leading IT organisations attend this camp to exchange knowledge and experiences on their innovations and to debate recent developments. Developers and users frequently contribute to Planet MySQL through blogs and discussions.

Also, Oracle University offers multiple courses to help MySQL users — from beginners to highly skilled database developers — stay updated and remain relevant.

Q What are the highlights of the latest MySQL release? What would be the 'Top 3' features that you'd like to share with our readers?

MySQL 8.0 offers a list of new features for database administrators to increase performance optimisation. For instance, it adds NoSQL features that appeal to the next generation of cloud-native developers.

Of the several key features of MySQL 8.0, I'd like to highlight the following three.

- **NoSQL Document Store:** This offers multi-document transaction support and full ACID compliance for schema-less JSON documents.
- **MySQL Shell:** This is a single interface for developing, deploying and managing MySQL instances. You can interact with MySQL from this interface in the language of your choice.
- **InnoDB cluster:** With this, high availability is now a core first class feature. **END** 